



Rowan Thistle

HEIR TO THISTLEDOWN HOUSE

*“Everyone assumes the jam fortune is yours.
Everyone may be in for a surprise.”*



✦ FOR YOUR EYES ONLY ✦

CORE CHARACTER

ALWAYS IN PLAY

WHAT TO WEAR

A tweed jacket or a soft cardigan, a silk scarf, and the slightly rumpled air of someone who will one day inherit a very large house and a very small budget for heating it.

At the table you are: charming, a little nervous, and always the first to toast Uncle Barty.



Before the party: read page 2 alone. It holds your story and your secret.



Starter served: open Round 1 on page 3 when the host calls it.



Main course served: unfold page 3 and open Round 2.



Dessert served: open Round 3 on page 4, then vote.

Printed single-sided, so later rounds can't show through.



THE EVENING

Autumn, the 1930s. Bartholomew “Barty” Thistle, retired jam magnate, has invited a few old friends to the Harvest Supper at Thistledown House. Before the soup was served, Barty took a glass of elderflower cordial in the study, sat down for a rest, and never woke up. Someone at this table knows why.

Never show this booklet to anyone. You may bend the truth about your secret, but never about the evidence.



You are innocent.

You did not harm Barty, and you want the truth to come out.

Your story

Barty is your late mother's brother, and you will inherit Thistledown House one day. Everybody knows it. You run a little bookshop in town, Thistle & Page, and it is sinking fast.

YOUR SECRET

At 5:35, just after Sage came out of the study, you went in and asked Barty for £200 to pay the printer. Barty wrote you a check, then tore it in two and said, "Balance your books first, then ask me." You left at about 5:42, embarrassed, and you would rather nobody knew.

Where you were

5:30	Arrived on the afternoon train.
5:35-5:42	In the study with Barty (the check).
5:45-6:30	At the drawing-room piano. Ellis sat by the fire listening the whole time.
about 6:25	Heard Barty in the hall calling, "Something smells marvelous!"
6:30	Sherry in the drawing room.

Your goal tonight

Find out who harmed your uncle. Keep the check quiet until Round 2. Try to win Best Detective.

If someone asks you...

"Do you inherit?" "The house, yes. Everyone knows that. It is mostly damp and drafts."

"Why did you go to the study?" Before Round 2: "To say hello to my uncle. Is that a crime?" From Round 2, tell the truth.

"Did you see the cordial?" "There was no glass on the desk while I was there. Only the blotter and the pens."

YOUR NOTES BEFORE THE PARTY

Rowan Thistle • Rounds 1 & 2

ONE ROUND AT A TIME



Round 1 • Starter

OPEN ONLY WHEN THE HOST CALLS IT

Read only when the Starter is served.

- SHARE THIS
- **(MUST SHARE)** From about a quarter to six until Morgan brought the sherry at half past six, I was playing the piano in the drawing room. Ellis sat by the fire and listened the whole time. Neither of us left the room.
 - I will inherit the house one day. I would much rather have Uncle Barty back.
- ASK
- **Morgan:** “When did you last see Uncle Barty, and where was Barty going?”
 - **Sage:** “You were shut in the study with my uncle just before me. What was that meeting about?”
- YOUR TASK
- Raise a toast to Uncle Barty before the first spoonful, and quietly note who doesn’t raise a glass.



FOLD OR CUT HERE • KEEP ROUND 2 HIDDEN UNTIL THE MAIN COURSE IS SERVED



Round 2 • Main Course

OPEN ONLY WHEN THE HOST CALLS IT

Read only when the Main Course is served.

- SHARE THIS
- **(MUST SHARE)** When I went into the study at 5:35, just after Sage came out, the desk was bare: the blotter, the pen tray and nothing else. No glass, no saucer and no note. I left at about 5:42.
 - Once Evidence #6 is out, admit it: the torn check was mine. I asked for £200 for the bookshop and Uncle Barty said no.
- ASK
- **Ellis:** “Who could get hold of a sleeping powder like that one?”
 - **Sage:** “Where exactly were you between a quarter to six and half past six?”
- YOUR TASK
- Read Evidence #5 aloud, then ask the table who writes in green ink.

NOTES • ROUNDS 1 AND 2

“MUST SHARE” lines are true and important. Say them during the round, in your own words.

Rowan Thistle • Round 3

THEN VOTE

OPEN ONLY WHEN THE HOST CALLS IT

Read only when the Dessert is served.

SHARE THIS

- At about 6:25 I heard Uncle Barty come in through the hall, calling out that supper smelled marvelous. That was the last time I heard that cheerful voice.
- Last month Uncle Barty grumbled to me that “the Trust accounts don’t add up.” I thought it was just grumbling.

ASK

- **Morgan:** “Who knew that Uncle Barty drank a glass of cordial before supper every evening?”
- **Sage:** “Who signs for money taken out of the Thistle Trust?”

YOUR TASK

Before the vote, tell the table which piece of evidence convinced you most, and why.

NOTES

SUSPECTS AT A GLANCE (PUBLIC INFORMATION)

#	NAME	ROLE	#	NAME	ROLE
10	Rowan Thistle	Heir to Thistledown House	14	Harper Vale	Food Critic
11	Ellis Fairweather	Family Doctor	15	Quinn Ashby	Head Gardener
12	Morgan Pike	Steward of Thistledown House	16	Avery Lark	Newspaper Reporter
13	Sage Whitlock	Family Solicitor	17	Jules Marchetti	Visiting Chef



Ellis

Fairweather

FAMILY DOCTOR

“Knows every heartbeat in Fernley, and every secret that comes with it.”

✦ FOR YOUR EYES ONLY ✦

CORE CHARACTER

ALWAYS IN PLAY

WHAT TO WEAR

A dark waistcoat or a tidy cardigan, a pocket watch on a chain, spectacles if you have them, and a battered leather doctor's bag (any handbag will do).

At the table you are: calm, precise and never quite off duty.

How this booklet works



Before the party: read page 2 alone. It holds your story and your secret.



Starter served: open Round 1 on page 3 when the host calls it.



Main course served: unfold page 3 and open Round 2.



Dessert served: open Round 3 on page 4, then vote.

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THE EVENING

Autumn, the 1930s. Bartholomew “Barty” Thistle, retired jam magnate, has invited a few old friends to the Harvest Supper at Thistledown House. Before the soup was served, Barty took a glass of elderflower cordial in the study, sat down for a rest, and never woke up. Someone at this table knows why.

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You are innocent.

You did not harm Barty, and you want the truth to come out.

Your story

You have been Barty's doctor for twenty years and you check Barty's heart every Saturday at five. Tonight it was as steady as a church clock. Barty had promised £1,000 for a new wing at Fernley Cottage Hospital, your life's work.

YOUR SECRET

At the five o'clock checkup Barty said the hospital money must wait: "The Trust money has gone astray, and I mean to find out where by Monday." You were bitterly disappointed and said something sharp. Worse, Dormital, a sleeping powder, is a medicine you prescribe, so eyes may turn to you.

Where you were

5:00 - 5:15	In the study, checking Barty's heart.
5:15 - 5:40	A walk on the terrace, then in to the drawing-room fire.
5:45 - 6:30	By the drawing-room fire, listening to Rowan play the piano. Neither of you left.
6:30	Sherry in the drawing room.
6:45	Morgan called you to the study. You could not wake Barty.

Your goal tonight

Show that the sleeping powder did not come from your bag. Find out who has been dipping into the Trust. Keep the hospital quarrel quiet until Round 3.

If someone asks you...

"Was Barty ill?" "A weak heart, well looked after. Barty would have seen ninety."

"What happened to Barty?" "Barty fell into a very deep sleep and never woke. Something in that glass did it."

"Do you carry sleeping powders?" "Never. My bag holds a stethoscope, heart drops and peppermints. Look for yourself."

YOUR NOTES BEFORE THE PARTY

Ellis Fairweather • Rounds 1 & 2

ONE ROUND AT A TIME



Round 1 • Starter

OPEN ONLY WHEN THE HOST CALLS IT

Read only when the Starter is served.

SHARE THIS • **MUST SHARE** From a quarter to six until the sherry at half past six, I sat by the drawing-room fire while Rowan played the piano. Neither of us left the room.

• Barty's heart was steady at five o'clock. This was no natural turn.

ASK

- **Morgan:** “Who poured Barty’s cordial tonight, and when?”
- **Sage:** “You came for a meeting before supper. Did it end happily?”

YOUR TASK Ask everyone at the table when they last saw Barty, and jot each time in your notes.



 FOLD OR CUT HERE · KEEP ROUND 2 HIDDEN UNTIL THE MAIN COURSE IS SERVED



Round 2 • Main Course

OPEN ONLY WHEN THE HOST CALLS IT

Read only when the Main Course is served.

SHARE THIS • **MUST SHARE** Dormital is a sleeping powder I prescribe. One sachet gives a gentle night's sleep. Two at once, on top of Barty's heart drops, would be far too strong. At this table I have prescribed it to one person only: Sage. I wrote the prescription yesterday.

- My bag holds no Dormital at all. Anyone may look.

ASK

- **Rowan:** “That torn check has your name on it. What happened in the study?”
- **Sage:** “How many Dormital sachets do you have with you tonight?”

YOUR TASK Hold up your doctor's bag (or any bag) and invite the table to look inside.

NOTES · ROUNDS 1 AND 2

“MUST SHARE” lines are true and important. Say them during the round, in your own words.

Ellis Fairweather • Round 3

THEN VOTE

Round 3 · Dessert

OPEN ONLY WHEN THE HOST CALLS IT

Read only when the Dessert is served.

SHARE THIS

- **MUST SHARE** At five o'clock Barty told me the hospital money must wait: "The Trust money has gone astray, and I mean to find out where by Monday."
- I was angry and I said so. But I wanted that wing built with Barty's blessing, not out of Barty's will.

ASK

- **Sage:** “As trustee, what were you going to tell Barty’s new lawyers on Monday?”
- **Morgan:** “Did anyone go near the study between six and half past six?”

YOUR TASK

Compare Evidence #4 and #7 aloud and count the sachets for the table.

NOTES

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Morgan Pike

STEWARD OF THISTLEDOWN HOUSE

“Twenty-five years of polishing the silver, and not one thing missed.”



✦ FOR YOUR EYES ONLY ✦

CORE CHARACTER

ALWAYS IN PLAY

WHAT TO WEAR

A crisp dark jacket or waistcoat, a white shirt, a ring of keys at the belt and a dusting cloth peeping from one pocket.

At the table you are: dignified, observant and a little protective of the house.

How this booklet works



Before the party: read page 2 alone. It holds your story and your secret.



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Main course served: unfold page 3 and open Round 2.



Dessert served: open Round 3 on page 4, then vote.

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THE EVENING

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You are innocent.

You did not harm Barty, and you want the truth to come out.

Your story

You have run Thistledown House for twenty-five years. Barty was difficult, generous and fond of routine: a glass of elderflower cordial in the study before supper, every evening without fail. Anyone who has stayed here knows it.

YOUR SECRET

Last spring, while dusting the study, you saw a draft of Barty's will. It leaves you the gate lodge and £500. You have never told a soul. You also poured tonight's glass, so you know eyes will turn to you.

Where you were

5:15 - 5:35	Polishing the hall table. You heard voices from the study.
5:45	Poured Barty's glass in the study.
5:50 - 6:30	In the kitchen with Cook and Dot, the housemaid: soup, then silver.
6:30	Carried the sherry tray to the drawing room.
6:45	Went to say supper was ready. You could not wake Barty, and fetched the doctor.

Your goal tonight

Protect the good name of the house and see the truth come out. Keep the will quiet until Round 3.

If someone asks you...

"Did you pour the cordial?" "I did, at a quarter to six, from a fresh bottle, as I have every evening for twenty-five years."

"Who are Cook and Dot?" "Cook runs the kitchen and Dot is the housemaid. Both were with me all evening."

"Do you gain anything?" Before Round 3: "I lose a household I have served half my life."

YOUR NOTES BEFORE THE PARTY

Morgan Pike • Rounds 1 & 2

ONE ROUND AT A TIME



Round 1 • Starter

OPEN ONLY WHEN THE HOST CALLS IT

Read only when the Starter is served.

SHARE THIS

- **(MUST SHARE)** At a quarter to six I opened a fresh bottle of cordial in the study, poured one glass and set a saucer on top to keep the wasps off. The desk held nothing else but the blotter and the pen tray. Barty said, “Back from the garden by half past six,” and went out through the terrace door.
- From ten to six I was down in the kitchen with Cook and Dot. Cook keeps a slate of everything.

ASK

- **Rowan:** “I saw you leave the study at about twenty to six looking upset. What did you and Barty talk about?”
- **Ellis:** “How was Barty’s heart at five o’clock?”

YOUR TASK

Ask each guest how they take their cordial, and note who seems to know Barty’s evening habit best.



FOLD OR CUT HERE • KEEP ROUND 2 HIDDEN UNTIL THE MAIN COURSE IS SERVED



Round 2 • Main Course

OPEN ONLY WHEN THE HOST CALLS IT

Read only when the Main Course is served.

SHARE THIS

- **(MUST SHARE)** From the hall I heard Barty and Sage in the study from 5:15 to 5:35. Barty’s voice was raised: “Every penny, Sage. By Monday.”
- After Barty went out to the garden, I did not set foot in the study again until 6:45, when I went to say supper was ready.

ASK

- **Sage:** “What did Barty mean by ‘every penny, by Monday’?”
- **Ellis:** “Could the powder have gone into the bottle instead of the glass?”

YOUR TASK

Look at Evidence #5 and tell the table exactly what was under that saucer when you set it down at 5:45: nothing at all.

NOTES • ROUNDS 1 AND 2

“MUST SHARE” lines are true and important. Say them during the round, in your own words.

Morgan Pike • Round 3

THEN VOTE

Round 3 · Dessert

OPEN ONLY WHEN THE HOST CALLS IT

Read only when the Dessert is served.

SHARE THIS

- Barty's will leaves me the gate lodge and £500. I saw it by accident last spring. I would give it all back for one more grumpy "good evening."
- Dot lit the library fire at about ten past six and came back saying nobody was in there.

ASK

- **Sage:** “You say you spent that hour in the library. Which papers were you reading, and was the fire lit?”
- **Rowan:** “Did Barty ever mention the Trust accounts to you?”

YOUR TASK

Pour (or mime pouring) a glass for the table and propose a toast: “To Thistledown.”

NOTES

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Sage Whitlock

FAMILY SOLICITOR

“Has drawn up every will in Fernley, and keeps every secret neatly filed.”



✦ FOR YOUR EYES ONLY ✦

CORE CHARACTER

ALWAYS IN PLAY

WHAT TO WEAR

A pinstriped suit or a smart dark dress, spectacles on a chain, and a leather document case tucked under one arm.

At the table you are: polished, reassuring and always ready with a precise answer.

How this booklet works



Before the party: read page 2 alone. It holds your story and your secret.



Starter served: open Round 1 on page 3 when the host calls it.



Main course served: unfold page 3 and open Round 2.



Dessert served: open Round 3 on page 4, then vote.

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THE EVENING

Autumn, the 1930s. Bartholomew “Barty” Thistle, retired jam magnate, has invited a few old friends to the Harvest Supper at Thistledown House. Before the soup was served, Barty took a glass of elderflower cordial in the study, sat down for a rest, and never woke up. Someone at this table knows why.

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You are the culprit.

Nobody must find out. Read every word of this page carefully.

What really happened

You are the sole trustee of the Thistle Trust. Over three years you quietly “borrowed” £4,000 from it to cover bad investments. At 5:15 tonight Barty told you the gap had been found and that everything would go to a London firm on Monday.

WHAT YOU DID

At about six, while Barty was out in the garden, you slipped into the study, stirred two sachets of your own Dormital sleeping powder into the waiting glass and dropped the papers into the fire. You tucked a note under the saucer so that, if anyone walked in, you were “only leaving Barty a note.” Then you went up to the Blue Room and came down at 6:30.

YOUR COVER STORY

After the meeting ended at 5:35 you left a friendly note on the desk, then sat in the library with your papers until the sherry at 6:30.

Where you were (the truth)

5:15 - 5:35	Meeting with Barty in the study.
5:35 - 6:00	Up in the Blue Room (you will say: the library).
about 6:00 - 6:08	In the study, alone with the glass.
6:08 - 6:30	Back upstairs, then down to the sherry.

Your goal tonight

Keep suspicion on the others: Rowan (the torn check), Ellis (Dormital is the doctor’s medicine) and Morgan (who poured the glass). You may lie about yourself, but never deny what an evidence card says. Stay unsuspected to win Best Performance.

If someone asks you...

“Do you take sleeping powder?” “Now and then, for my nerves. Half of Fernley does.”
 “What was the meeting about?” “The quarterly statement for the Trust. All in order, as you will see.”
 “Where were you at six?” “In the library, with my papers and the quiet.”

YOUR NOTES BEFORE THE PARTY

Sage Whitlock • Rounds 1 & 2

ONE ROUND AT A TIME



Round 1 • Starter

OPEN ONLY WHEN THE HOST CALLS IT

Read only when the Starter is served.

SHARE THIS • Barty asked me down to go over the Thistle Trust's quarterly statement. I brought it in that envelope (Evidence #3). All perfectly in order.

- Rowan was very keen to see Barty alone straight after me. I would ask why.

ASK

- **Rowan:** “Who inherits Thistledown House now?”

- **Morgan:** “Who poured Barty’s glass tonight, and who handled the bottle?”

YOUR TASK

Steer the talk to Evidence #1 and wonder aloud who could have walked into the study.



 FOLD OR CUT HERE · KEEP ROUND 2 HIDDEN UNTIL THE MAIN COURSE IS SERVED



Round 2 • Main Course

OPEN ONLY WHEN THE HOST CALLS IT

Read only when the Main Course is served.

SHARE THIS • Yes, the green-ink note is mine. Say you left it as you came out of your meeting, at about twenty to six.

- Remind everyone that Dormital is Dr. Fairweather's prescription. Who knows what is in that doctor's bag?

ASK

- **Ellis:** “Who in Fernley do you prescribe Dormital to?”

- **Rowan:** “That torn check. How much did you ask Barty for?”

YOUR TASK

Keep the table talking about money troubles: bring up Evidence #6 at least twice.

NOTES · ROUNDS 1 AND 2

“MUST SHARE” lines are true and important. Say them during the round, in your own words.

Sage Whitlock • Round 3

THEN VOTE

Round 3 · Dessert

OPEN ONLY WHEN THE HOST CALLS IT

Read only when the Dessert is served.

SHARE THIS

- If the box in the Blue Room comes up, insist it sat open on the washstand where anyone could reach it.
- Barty worried about money all the time. Nobody should read anything into an old client's grumbling.

ASK

- **Morgan:** “You had the bottle and the glass in your hands. Why should we believe you?”
- **Ellis:** “You were angry with Barty this evening. About what?”

YOUR TASK

Before the vote, cast calm, reasonable doubt on one other suspect.

NOTES

SUSPECTS AT A GLANCE (PUBLIC INFORMATION)

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Harper Vale

FOOD CRITIC

“Has never met a dish that couldn’t be improved by a sharper adjective.”



✦ FOR YOUR EYES ONLY ✦

OPTIONAL · JOINS AT 5+

WHAT TO WEAR

A velvet jacket, a bold bow tie or brooch, and a little notebook and pencil for taking notes on every course.

At the table you are: theatrical, witty and impossible to impress.

How this booklet works



Before the party: read page 2 alone. It holds your story and your secret.



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You are innocent.

You did not harm Barty, and you want the truth to come out.

You are an optional character. If you are not in the game, nothing breaks.

Your story

You write the “Table Talk” column for the London Evening Courier. Last spring you wrote that Thistle’s Harvest Jam “tastes of regret and boiled string.” Tonight’s invitation was either a peace offering or a trap.

YOUR SECRET

Last week a solicitor’s letter on Barty’s behalf demanded £300 and a printed apology for your review. You have no intention of paying. You also wandered down the study corridor at about 5:40, looking for the telephone.

Where you were

5:30	Arrived by motor car.
about 5:40	Down the study corridor looking for the telephone.
5:45–6:10	In the dining room, admiring the table.
6:10–6:25	On the hall telephone to the Courier. The operator rang back at 6:25 with the charges.
6:30	Sherry in the drawing room.

Your goal tonight

Get a scoop for your column and find the truth. Keep the lawsuit quiet until Round 2.

If someone asks you...

“Did you hate Barty?” “I hated the jam. Barty I rather liked.”

“Why were you in the hall?” “Telephoning my editor. The operator will confirm the time.”

“Did you see anything?” “From the telephone I can see the main stairs, and not much else.”

YOUR NOTES BEFORE THE PARTY

Harper Vale • Rounds 1 & 2

ONE ROUND AT A TIME



Round 1 • Starter

OPEN ONLY WHEN THE HOST CALLS IT

Read only when the Starter is served.

SHARE THIS

- I came to write a column about the Harvest Supper. I did not come to like Barty's jam.
- From about ten past six until twenty-five past I was on the hall telephone to my editor. The operator rang back with the charges at 6:25.

ASK

- **Morgan:** “What did Barty plan for tonight’s menu?”
- **Rowan:** “Did Barty ever forgive anybody for anything?”

YOUR TASK Taste the starter with great ceremony and give it a short spoken review.



 FOLD OR CUT HERE · KEEP ROUND 2 HIDDEN UNTIL THE MAIN COURSE IS SERVED



Round 2 · Main Course

OPEN ONLY WHEN THE HOST CALLS IT

Read only when the Main Course is served.

SHARE THIS

- A solicitor's letter on Barty's behalf demanded £300 and an apology for my review. The solicitor who signed it is sitting at this table.
- As I hung up at 6:25, I saw Sage coming down the main stairs. Not out of the library, mind. Down the stairs.

ASK

- **Sage:** “Do you always write such fierce letters for your clients?”
- **Ellis:** “Is it true that Barty’s heart was strong?”

YOUR TASK Write a one-line “review” of another suspect’s alibi in your notes and read it out.

NOTES · ROUNDS 1 AND 2

“MUST SHARE” lines are true and important. Say them during the round, in your own words.

Harper Vale • Round 3

THEN VOTE

Round 3 · Dessert

OPEN ONLY WHEN THE HOST CALLS IT

Read only when the Dessert is served.

SHARE THIS

- I admit I wandered down the study corridor at about 5:40, looking for the telephone. The door was shut and I heard Barty and Rowan talking about money.
- Word in London is that a country solicitor has been “living rather above their means.”

ASK

- **Sage:** “How does a country solicitor afford a new motor car?”
- **Rowan:** “What did you and Barty argue about at twenty to six?”

YOUR TASK Award the evening's best course a star rating out of five, aloud.

NOTES

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Quinn Ashby

HEAD GARDENER

“Grows the finest marrows in the county, and holds a grudge just as well.”



✦ FOR YOUR EYES ONLY ✦

OPTIONAL · JOINS AT 6+

WHAT TO WEAR

A flat cap or a headscarf, rolled sleeves, a canvas apron or waistcoat, and a sprig of thistle or wheat in a buttonhole.

At the table you are: plain-spoken, proud of the garden and short on patience for fuss.

How this booklet works



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You are innocent.

You did not harm Barty, and you want the truth to come out.

You are an optional character. If you are not in the game, nothing breaks.

Your story

You have been head gardener for twelve years. You make the elderflower cordial every June, bottle by bottle, and you grew the prize marrow Barty meant to show at the county fair.

YOUR SECRET

Barty planned to sell the walled garden to a jam factory. You would lose your work and your cottage. Last week you told Barty, “Over my dead marrows,” and half the kitchen heard it.

Where you were

5:50-6:20 In the kitchen garden with Barty, weighing the prize marrow.

6:20 Barty went in through the terrace door. You stayed to shut the cold frames.

6:20 - 6:40 Washing up in the potting shed.

6:45 Heard the alarm from the house.

Your goal tonight

Defend your cordial and your garden. Help the table see who was really near that glass. Keep the garden sale quiet until Round 2.

If someone asks you...

“Did you make the cordial?” “Every drop. And every bottle in that pantry is as clean as rain.”

“Where were you?” “In the kitchen garden with Barty, weighing a marrow. It is in Barty’s own ledger.”

“Were you angry with Barty?” “Gardeners are always angry about something. Usually slugs.”

YOUR NOTES BEFORE THE PARTY

[illegible]

Quinn Ashby · Rounds 1 & 2

ONE ROUND AT A TIME



Round 1 • Starter

OPEN ONLY WHEN THE HOST CALLS IT

Read only when the Starter is served.

SHARE THIS • I make the cordial every June. Every bottle in that pantry is clean. I would stake my marrows on it.

- I was with Barty in the kitchen garden from ten to six until twenty past six, weighing the prize marrow. Thirty-one pounds.

ASK

- **Morgan:** “Who opened tonight’s fresh bottle, and where did it come from?”
- **Harper:** “Did your famous review mention my garden?”

YOUR TASK Describe your prize marrow to the table in loving detail.



 FOLD OR CUT HERE · KEEP ROUND 2 HIDDEN UNTIL THE MAIN COURSE IS SERVED



Round 2 · Main Course

OPEN ONLY WHEN THE HOST CALLS IT

Read only when the Main Course is served.

SHARE THIS • Barty meant to sell the walled garden to a jam factory. I was furious, and I won't pretend I wasn't.

- In the garden Barty said to me: “Somebody has been helping themselves to the Trust, Quinn. I’ll have it out tonight.”

ASK

- **Sage:** “Who looks after the Thistle Trust’s money?”
- **Ellis:** “What did Barty seem worried about at five o’clock?”

YOUR TASK Ask the table to guess the weight of the prize marrow. The closest guess gets a toast.

NOTES · ROUNDS 1 AND 2

“MUST SHARE” lines are true and important. Say them during the round, in your own words.

Quinn Ashby • Round 3

THEN VOTE

Round 3 • Dessert

OPEN ONLY WHEN THE HOST CALLS IT

Read only when the Dessert is served.

SHARE THIS

- When Barty went in at 6:20, Barty was whistling and perfectly well.
- I have never once been inside the Blue Room. Ask Morgan.

ASK

- **Rowan:** “Will you sell the walled garden now?”
- **Sage:** “Why would anyone hide a note under a saucer?”

YOUR TASK

Before the vote, name one suspect you have now ruled out, and say why.

NOTES

SUSPECTS AT A GLANCE (PUBLIC INFORMATION)

#	NAME	ROLE	#	NAME	ROLE
10	Rowan Thistle	Heir to Thistledown House	14	Harper Vale	Food Critic
11	Ellis Fairweather	Family Doctor	15	Quinn Ashby	Head Gardener
12	Morgan Pike	Steward of Thistledown House	16	Avery Lark	Newspaper Reporter
13	Sage Whitlock	Family Solicitor	17	Jules Marchetti	Visiting Chef



Avery Lark

NEWSPAPER REPORTER

“Always one question away from the story of the year.”



✦ FOR YOUR EYES ONLY ✦

OPTIONAL · JOINS AT 7+

WHAT TO WEAR

A trench coat or a belted cardigan, a hat with a card tucked in the band reading “PRESS,” and a pencil behind one ear.

At the table you are: curious, quick and forever scribbling.

How this booklet works



Before the party: read page 2 alone. It holds your story and your secret.



Starter served: open Round 1 on page 3 when the host calls it.



Main course served: unfold page 3 and open Round 2.



Dessert served: open Round 3 on page 4, then vote.

Printed single-sided, so later rounds can't show through.



THE EVENING

Autumn, the 1930s. Bartholomew “Barty” Thistle, retired jam magnate, has invited a few old friends to the Harvest Supper at Thistledown House. Before the soup was served, Barty took a glass of elderflower cordial in the study, sat down for a rest, and never woke up. Someone at this table knows why.

Never show this booklet to anyone. You may bend the truth about your secret, but never about the evidence.



You are innocent.

You did not harm Barty, and you want the truth to come out.

You are an optional character. If you are not in the game, nothing breaks.

Your story

You report for the Fernley Gazette and were invited to cover the Harvest Supper for the society page. That is what you told everyone, anyway.

YOUR SECRET

Last week an unsigned letter came to the Gazette: “Ask who signs the Thistle Trust’s checks. £4,000 says it’s worth a story.” At 6:40 you slipped into the study hoping to see the Trust papers. Barty was in the armchair with eyes closed. You thought Barty was dozing and tiptoed out, leaving your pencil behind.

Where you were

- 6:30 Arrived by the station taxi (the late train was delayed).
- 6:30 - 6:40 Sherry in the drawing room.
- 6:40 - 6:43 In the study (your secret).
- 6:45 Back in the drawing room when Morgan raised the alarm.

Your goal tonight

Get the real story, and find the truth before morning. Keep the study visit quiet until Round 2 and the letter quiet until Round 3.

If someone asks you...

- “When did you arrive?” “Half past six, on the station taxi. The driver will swear to it.”
- “Why are you here?” “The society page. Hats, menus, who sat next to whom.”
- “Is that your pencil in the study?” From Round 2: admit it.

YOUR NOTES BEFORE THE PARTY

Avery Lark • Rounds 1 & 2

ONE ROUND AT A TIME



Round 1 · Starter

OPEN ONLY WHEN THE HOST CALLS IT

Read only when the Starter is served.

SHARE THIS • My train was late. The station taxi set me down at the door at half past six, and the driver will swear to it.

- I am here for the society page. Hats, menus, who sat next to whom.

ASK

- **Rowan:** “How does it feel to be the heir of Thistledown?”

- **Harper:** “Have you ever written a kind word about anyone?”

YOUR TASK

Take a pretend photograph of the three best-dressed suspects for the Gazette.



 FOLD OR CUT HERE · KEEP ROUND 2 HIDDEN UNTIL THE MAIN COURSE IS SERVED



Round 2 · Main Course

OPEN ONLY WHEN THE HOST CALLS IT

Read only when the Main Course is served.

SHARE THIS • I peeked into the study at 6:40. Barty was in the armchair with eyes closed. I thought Barty was napping and tiptoed out. I am so sorry.

- The glass on the desk was already empty, with the saucer beside it.

ASK

- **Morgan:** “When did you last see Barty awake?”

- **Quinn:** “What was Barty like out in the garden?”

YOUR TASK

Interview one suspect for exactly one minute while the others time you.

NOTES · ROUNDS 1 AND 2

“MUST SHARE” lines are true and important. Say them during the round, in your own words.

Avery Lark · Round 3

THEN VOTE

Round 3 · Dessert

OPEN ONLY WHEN THE HOST CALLS IT

Read only when the Dessert is served.

SHARE THIS • Last week an unsigned letter came to the Gazette: “Ask who signs the Thistle Trust’s checks. £4,000 says it’s worth a story.”

- That is the real reason I came tonight.

ASK • **Sage:** “Who signs the Thistle Trust’s checks?”

- **Ellis:** “Was the hospital wing ever going to be paid for by the Trust?”

YOUR TASK Read out tomorrow's Gazette headline as you imagine it.

NOTES

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13	Sage Whitlock	Family Solicitor	17	Jules Marchetti	Visiting Chef



Jules Marchetti

VISITING CHEF

"Came to write a cookbook. Stayed for the drama."



✦ FOR YOUR EYES ONLY ✦

OPTIONAL · JOINS AT 8

WHAT TO WEAR

A white chef's jacket or an apron over smart clothes, a neckerchief, and a wooden spoon to wave for emphasis.

At the table you are: passionate, generous and quick to take offense on behalf of a sauce.

How this booklet works



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Main course served: unfold page 3 and open Round 2.



Dessert served: open Round 3 on page 4, then vote.

Printed single-sided, so later rounds can't show through.



THE EVENING

Autumn, the 1930s. Bartholomew "Barty" Thistle, retired jam magnate, has invited a few old friends to the Harvest Supper at Thistledown House. Before the soup was served, Barty took a glass of elderflower cordial in the study, sat down for a rest, and never woke up. Someone at this table knows why.

Never show this booklet to anyone. You may bend the truth about your secret, but never about the evidence.



You are innocent.

You did not harm Barty, and you want the truth to come out.

You are an optional character. If you are not in the game, nothing breaks.

Your story

You are a chef from a grand Brighton hotel, staying at Thistledown for the autumn to write a cookbook with Barty. You created a new recipe, Thistledown Harvest Jam, and Barty planned to sell it under the Thistle name without a word of credit to you.

YOUR SECRET

At four o'clock you and Barty quarreled in the kitchen about the recipe. You shouted, "You will regret this supper!" and Cook heard every word.

Where you were

- 4:00 Quarreled with Barty in the kitchen.
- 5:45 - 6:30 Setting the dining table and arranging the flowers. Harper kept you company until 6:10, then was on the hall telephone in plain sight through the open door.
- about 6:05 Heard the study door click shut across the hall, then footsteps going up the main stairs.
- 6:30 Sherry in the drawing room.

Your goal tonight

Clear your name and get credit for your jam. Keep the quarrel quiet until Round 2.

If someone asks you...

- "Did you cook tonight?" "I planned it. Cook cooked it. I set the table like a painting."
- "Did you touch the cordial?" "Cordial? I am a chef, not a gardener. Ask Quinn."
- "Where were you?" "In the dining room, with Harper in view through the door."

YOUR NOTES BEFORE THE PARTY

Jules Marchetti • Rounds 1 & 2

ONE ROUND AT A TIME



Round 1 • Starter

OPEN ONLY WHEN THE HOST CALLS IT

Read only when the Starter is served.

SHARE THIS

- I planned every course tonight, so tell me honestly what you think of the starter.
- From a quarter to six until the sherry I was in the dining room. Harper was with me, then on the hall telephone where I could see the whole time.

ASK

- **Harper:** “Will tonight’s supper appear in your column?”
- **Quinn:** “Who made the cordial in Barty’s glass?”

YOUR TASK

Describe the main course as if it were a love poem.



 FOLD OR CUT HERE · KEEP ROUND 2 HIDDEN UNTIL THE MAIN COURSE IS SERVED



Round 2 • Main Course

OPEN ONLY WHEN THE HOST CALLS IT

Read only when the Main Course is served.

SHARE THIS

- At four o'clock Barty and I quarreled about my jam recipe. I said, "You will regret this supper!" I meant the menu, I promise.
- At about five past six I heard the study door click shut across the hall, then footsteps going up the main stairs.

ASK

- **Sage:** “Are you staying the night upstairs?”
- **Avery:** “What did you see when you arrived?”

YOUR TASK

Ask each suspect for one word to describe Barty. Note them down.

NOTES · ROUNDS 1 AND 2

“MUST SHARE” lines are true and important. Say them during the round, in your own words.

Jules Marchetti · Round 3

THEN VOTE

Round 3 · Dessert

OPEN ONLY WHEN THE HOST CALLS IT

Read only when the Dessert is served.

SHARE THIS

- The footsteps on the stairs at five past six were quick and light, like someone who did not want to be heard.
- Barty promised me credit for the jam in the cookbook. Now I will never know.

ASK

- **Rowan:** “Will you still publish our cookbook?”
- **Morgan:** “Who sleeps in the rooms at the top of the main stairs?”

YOUR TASK

Serve (or mime serving) dessert with a flourish and name the dish.

NOTES

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